

يَا أَيُّهَا النَّاسُ كُلُوا مِمَّا فِي الْأَرْضِ حَلَالًا طَيِّبًا وَلَا تَتَّبِعُوا
حُطُوتِ الشَّيْطَانِ إِنَّهُ لَكُمْ عَدُوٌّ مُبِينٌ.
وَقَالَ رَسُولُ اللَّهِ صَلَّى اللَّهُ عَلَيْهِ وَسَلَّمَ:
إِنَّ الْحَلَالَ بَيِّنٌ وَإِنَّ الْحَرَامَ بَيِّنٌ ...

CONSCIOUSNESS OF HALAL AND HARAM

Honorable Muslims!

Halal and haram are divine ordinances through which a servant attains the pleasure of Allah the Almighty. They are guiding principles that show a person the path between good and evil throughout the journey of life. We also know from the statement of the Prophet Muhammad (saw), “**The halal is clear, and the haram is clear...**”,¹ that halal and haram have been made manifest beyond doubt.

Dear Believers!

Every command and prohibition conveyed to us through the religion of Islam embodies profound wisdom, such as preserving human dignity, safeguarding future generations, and maintaining peace and harmony within society. For example, Allah the Almighty has made marriage, which ensures the continuation of the human race, halal, while declaring adultery haram through the noble verse: “**Do not go near adultery. It is truly a shameful deed and an evil way.**”² Likewise, while Allah the Almighty has made halal for us trade, earning through the sweat of one’s brow, and honest labor—means by which order and justice are established in society—He has made usury, cheating in weights and measures, concealing the defects of merchandise, and, in short, deceiving people haram.

Esteemed Muslims!

We should also know that consciousness to halal and haram is not limited to ensuring that the food placed on our table is pure. For example, the noble verses, “**Tell the believing men to lower their gaze and guard their chastity... And tell the believing women to lower their gaze and guard their chastity...**”³ point to a matter of the utmost importance that elevates human dignity: modesty and chastity. Therefore, every Muslim, whether man or woman, must safeguard their chastity, observe

modesty in dress and appearance, and refrain from all conduct that undermines human dignity. What befits a Muslim is to recognize that modesty, chastity, and good moral character derive their true meaning when they are upheld together. This requires observing the limits of privacy both in social life and on digital platforms, keeping one’s tongue away from falsehood, and one’s gaze away from what is haram.

Honorable Believers!

The same is true of wastefulness, which destroys the spirit of sharing and stands as one of the greatest obstacles to the just distribution of Allah’s blessings. At a time when millions of people in different parts of the world are in need of a morsel of bread and a drop of water, and while wastefulness has been forbidden to us,⁴ the fact that tons of bread are thrown away in our country and that our water resources are consumed irresponsibly is a clear indication that the boundaries of halal and haram have been transgressed.

Dear Brothers and Sisters!

We are witnessing an age about which the Messenger of Mercy (saw) warned us, saying, “**...A time will come when a person will no longer care whether his wealth has been acquired through halal or through haram.**”⁵ We are confronted with the challenges of an era in which what is halal is belittled and despised, what is haram is glamorized, and illegitimate words and actions are regarded as acceptable. Let us never forget that refraining from violating people’s lives, property, honor, and dignity; abstaining from misappropriating public property; and keeping away from evils such as bribery, usury, theft, intoxicants, drugs, and gambling can only be achieved by remaining steadfast upon the Straight Path that Allah the Almighty has established through His divine standards of halal and haram.

We conclude this week’s khutbah with the following call of Allah the Almighty: “**O humanity! Eat from what is lawful and good on the earth and do not follow Satan’s footsteps. He is truly your sworn enemy.**”⁶

¹ Muslim, Musaqah, 107.

² Isra, 17/32.

³ Nur, 24/30, 31.

⁴ A’raf, 7/31.

⁵ Bukhari, Buyu’, 23.

⁶ Baqarah, 2/168.

